BUTTERNUT SQUASH RAVIOLI

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
6	**3 h**

INGREDIENTS

1	Ravioli Filling — butternut squash, peeled and diced
1	Ravioli Filling — black truffle, grated
50 g	Ravioli Filling — pecorino cheese
to taste	Ravioli Filling — salt
400 g	Saffron Pasta Dough — pasta flour
5	Saffron Pasta Dough — egg yolks
5 g	Saffron Pasta Dough — saffron threads
10 g	Saffron Pasta Dough — salt
1	Saffron Pasta Dough — egg (for egg wash)
20 g	Sage Butter Sauce — butter
2	Sage Butter Sauce — sage leaves, chopped
15 ml	Sage Butter Sauce — lemon juice
to taste	Sage Butter Sauce — salt

METHOD

1. Prepare the squash: Cook the diced butternut squash in a pan with a little butter until very soft. Blend in a food processor and pass through a sieve. Hang in muslin cloth in fridge to dry out overnight - this is crucial for proper filling texture.
2. Make saffron pasta: Add saffron threads to 200ml of water in a pan and bring to a simmer. Reduce until almost dry with approximately 20ml liquid remaining. Mix saffron liquid with egg yolks. Combine salt and flour in food processor, pulse in egg yolk mixture slowly until just combined - it should resemble large breadcrumbs. If too dry, add 1/2 egg yolk. Turn out and knead until smooth. Wrap and rest in fridge for 2 hours.
3. Prepare filling: Once thoroughly strained, mix the butternut squash with grated truffle, pecorino and salt to taste.
4. Roll pasta: Remove dough from fridge and leave at room temperature. Roll through pasta machine, putting through 4 times on each setting until down to number 1 thickness. Lightly flour to prevent sticking.
5. Form ravioli: Cut at least 36, 20cm circles (cut extra in case of breakage). Lightly brush bottom half with egg wash. Place heaped tablespoon of filling in middle. Top with dry circle, seal edges, removing all air. Create neat flying saucer shape. Place on lightly flour tray in fridge for 30 minutes.
6. Cook and serve: Bring large pot salted water to boil. For sauce, melt butter over medium heat, make beurre noisette - let foam and brown. Add chopped sage, then lemon juice and salt. Drop ravioli into boiling water for 3 minutes, add to sauce and gently toss. Garnish with fresh chopped sage.

NOTES

In this gorgeous ravioli recipe, the pasta parcels are filled with a sweet butternut squash centre, resulting in a gorgeous vegetarian dish. The sauce is simply prepared with butter and chopped sage, but the pasta dough and ravioli filling do require some preparation ahead of time. The result is well worth the effort.
Chef's Tips: The overnight drying of the squash is essential - wet filling will make the ravioli burst. The saffron adds a beautiful golden color and subtle floral notes. Use the best quality truffle you can afford - it's the star of this dish.

FILLING

Butternut Squash and Truffle Filling

INGREDIENTS

1	Butternut squash, peeled and diced
1	Black truffle, grated
50 g	Pecorino cheese
to taste	Salt
a little	Butter, for cooking the squash

METHOD

1. Cook the diced squash in a pan with a little butter until very soft.
2. Blend in a food processor and pass through a sieve.
3. Hang in muslin in the fridge overnight to drain.
4. Once thoroughly strained, mix in the grated truffle and pecorino and season with salt.

NOTES

> The overnight drain is the step that matters. A wet mix bursts the ravioli in the water.
> A heaped tablespoon per raviolo, between 20 cm circles pressed into a flying-saucer shape.
> The source calls truffle the star of the dish and says to buy the best you can afford.
> Butter is called for in the method but carries no quantity beyond "a little" and does not appear in the source's ingredient list.

SHAPE

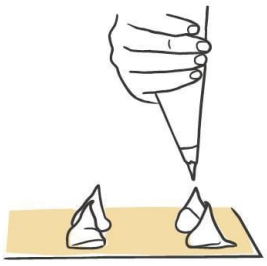
Ravioli

Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

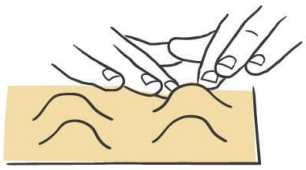
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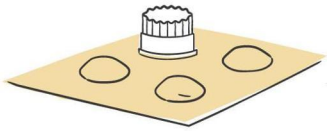
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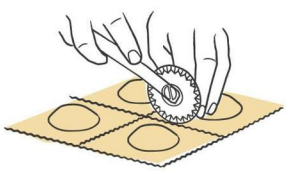
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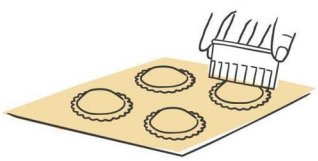
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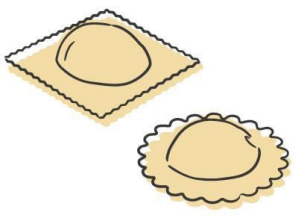
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NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.
Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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